



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

does free
will explain
all evil?

Most people are initially inclined to
reject premise (1).

But this faces some challenges.

First, God is free and yet never brings about any evil; so why should it be impossible to be free and never bring about any evil?

Second, many think that God wants us never to bring about any evil. Is God then wishing for something impossible? Was God simply confused in wishing for this?

1. It is possible for all people to have free will and yet never bring about any evil.
2. God can bring about any possible situation.

C. God could have made a world where all people have free will and yet never bring about any evil. (1,2)

MACKIE'S ARGUMENT AGAINST THE FWD

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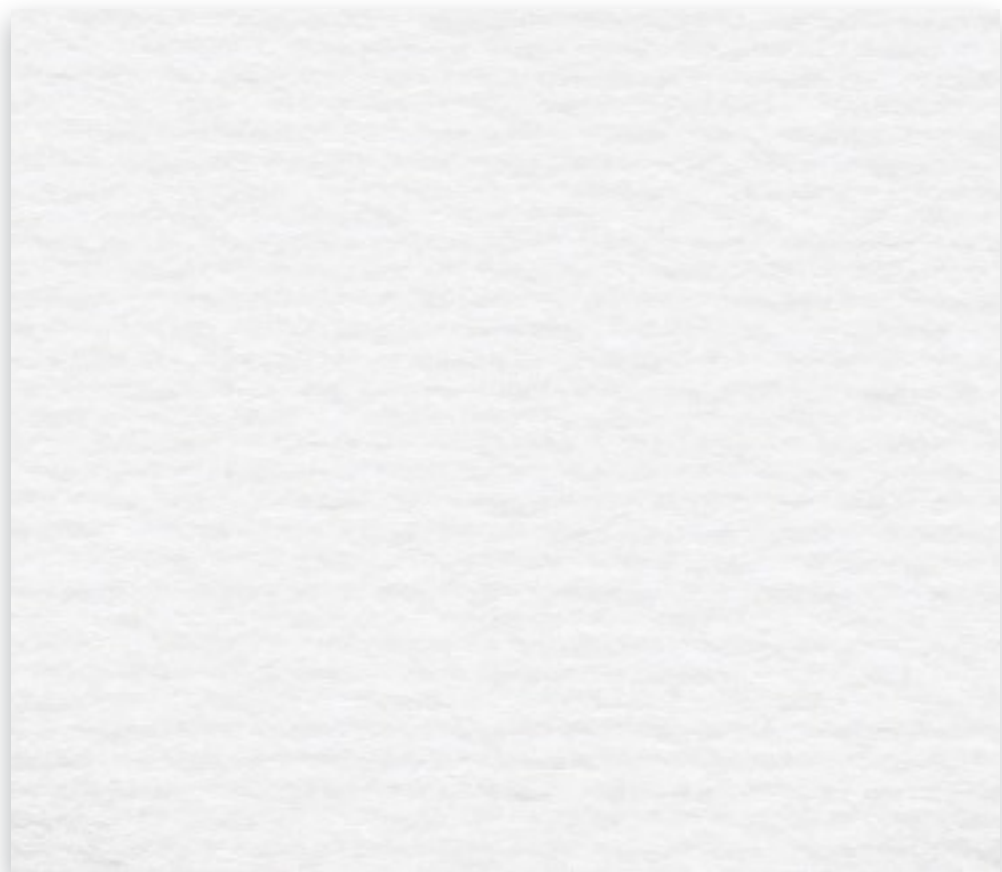
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C. Goodrich had made a

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**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

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